

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Temple Architecture and Chandella Khajuraho - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Temple Architecture and Chandella Khajuraho	
REFRESHED TEACHING NAVIGATION — BASIC/CORE FIRST	
01	FOUNDATION — TEMPLE SPACE AND RITUAL MOVEMENT Evidence chain: Temple spatial lexicon Qualified use: Build the
02	FOUNDATION — FROM GUPTA SHRINE TO REGIONAL SCHOOLS Evidence chain: Gupta developmental stages - Nagara and Dravida
03	FOUNDATION — HOW TO USE VESARA Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material;
04	CORE — CHANDELLA SOVEREIGNTY AND PATRONAGE Evidence chain: Chandella political setting Qualified use: Link power
05	CORE — KHAJURAHO PLAN AND MASSING Evidence chain: Khajuraho axial chain Qualified use: Describe mature
06	CORE — MATERIAL, TERRACE AND ENCLOSURE Evidence chain: Khajuraho material and enclosure Qualified use: Tie
07	CORE — PLURAL PATRONAGE AT KHAJURAHO Evidence chain: Plural sacred programme Qualified use: Use
08	CORE — VIGOUR AND BREADTH Evidence chain: Vigour and breadth of life - Kandariya Mahadeva
09	CORE — CHAUSATH YOGINI IDENTIFICATION Evidence chain: Chausath Yogini distinction Qualified use: Defeat a
10	CORE — PALLAVA TRANSITION Evidence chain: Pallava transition Qualified use: Prepare the 2024
11	CORE — CHOLA LIVING ACHIEVEMENT Evidence chain: Chola achievement Qualified use: Prepare the 2024
12	CORE — DECCAN EXPERIMENT Evidence chain: Chalukya and Hoysala experiment Qualified use:
13	CORE SYNTHESIS — VIJAYANAGARA AND NAYAKA Evidence chain: Vijayanagara temple-secular split - Nayaka expansion
14	CORE SYNTHESIS — EASTERN MATERIAL LOGIC Classification: Historical facts below are source-backed; causal weight
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Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Temple spatial lexicon?

A. Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhamandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels. B. Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida. C. Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram. D. Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans.

Answer: A. Explanation: Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhamandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under Temple spatial lexicon?

A. Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram. B. Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhamandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels. C. Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context. D. Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida.

Answer: B. Explanation: Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhamandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Temple spatial lexicon?

A. Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context. B. A high jagati supports ardhamandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas. C. Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhamandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels. D. Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida.

Answer: C. Explanation: Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhamandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Temple spatial lexicon?

A. Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context. B. A high jagati supports ardhamandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas. C. Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim. D. Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhamandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels.

Answer: D. Explanation: Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhamandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Gupta developmental stages?

A. Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans. B. Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram. C. Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context. D. Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida.

Answer: A. Explanation: Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under Gupta developmental stages?

A. A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas. B. Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans. C. Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida. D. Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context.

Answer: B. Explanation: Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Gupta developmental stages?

A. A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas. B. Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context. C. Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans. D. Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim.

Answer: C. Explanation: Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Gupta developmental stages?

A. Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim. B. Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom. C. A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas. D. Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans.

Answer: D. Explanation: Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Nagara and Dravida?

A. Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram. B. A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas. C. Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida. D. Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context.

Answer: A. Explanation: Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under Nagara and Dravida?

A. Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim. B. Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram. C. Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context. D. A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas.

Answer: B. Explanation: Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Nagara and Dravida?

A. A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas. B. Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim. C. Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram. D. Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom.

Answer: C. Explanation: Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Nagara and Dravida?

A. Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth. B. Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom. C. Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim. D. Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram.

Answer: D. Explanation: Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Vesara caution?

A. Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida. B. Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim. C. A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas. D. Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context.

Answer: A. Explanation: Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under Vesara caution?

A. Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom. B. Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida. C. Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim. D. A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas.

Answer: B. Explanation: Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Vesara caution?

A. Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim. B. Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom. C. Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida. D. Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth.

Answer: C. Explanation: Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Vesara caution?

A. The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture. B. Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom. C. Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth. D. Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida.

Answer: D. Explanation: Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Chandella political setting?

A. Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context. B. Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim. C. Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom. D. A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas.

Answer: A. Explanation: Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under Chandella political setting?

A. Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom. B. Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context. C. Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim. D. Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth.

Answer: B. Explanation: Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Chandella political setting?

A. Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom. B. Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth. C. Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context. D. The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture.

Answer: C. Explanation: Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Chandella political setting?

A. The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture. B. Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena. C. Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth. D. Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context.

Answer: D. Explanation: Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Khajuraho axial chain?

A. A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas. B. Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim. C. Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom. D. Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth.

Answer: A. Explanation: A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under Khajuraho axial chain?

A. Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom. B. A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas. C. The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture. D. Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth.

Answer: B. Explanation: A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Khajuraho axial chain?

A. Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth. B. The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture. C. A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas. D. Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena.

Answer: C. Explanation: A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Khajuraho axial chain?

A. Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena. B. Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters. C. The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture. D. A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas.

Answer: D. Explanation: A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Khajuraho material and enclosure?

A. Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim. B. Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth. C. The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture. D. Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom.

Answer: A. Explanation: Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under Khajuraho material and enclosure?

A. Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth. B. Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim. C. Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena. D. The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture.

Answer: B. Explanation: Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Khajuraho material and enclosure?

A. Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters. B. Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena. C. Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim. D. The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture.

Answer: C. Explanation: Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Khajuraho material and enclosure?

A. Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters. B. Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena. C. Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax. D. Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim.

Answer: D. Explanation: Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Plural sacred programme?

A. Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom. B. Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyālas and maithuna create breadth. C. Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena. D. The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture.

Answer: A. Explanation: Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under Plural sacred programme?

A. The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture. B. Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom. C. Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters. D. Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena.

Answer: B. Explanation: Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Plural sacred programme?

A. Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena. B. Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters. C. Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom. D. Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax.

Answer: C. Explanation: Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Plural sacred programme?

A. Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax. B. Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars. C. Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters. D. Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom.

Answer: D. Explanation: Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Vigour and breadth of life?

A. Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth. B. Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters. C. The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture. D. Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena.

Answer: A. Explanation: Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under Vigour and breadth of life?

A. Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax. B. Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth. C. Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena. D. Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters.

Answer: B. Explanation: Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Vigour and breadth of life?

A. Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax. B. Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars. C. Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth. D. Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters.

Answer: C. Explanation: Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Vigour and breadth of life?

A. Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars. B. Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone. C. Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax. D. Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth.

Answer: D. Explanation: Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Kandariya Mahadeva?

A. The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture. B. Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena. C. Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters. D. Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax.

Answer: A. Explanation: The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under Kandariya Mahadeva?

A. Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax. B. The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture. C. Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars. D. Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters.

Answer: B. Explanation: The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Kandariya Mahadeva?

A. Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax. B. Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone. C. The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture. D. Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars.

Answer: C. Explanation: The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Kandariya Mahadeva?

A. Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars. B. Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone. C. Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls. D. The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture.

Answer: D. Explanation: The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Chausath Yogini distinction?

A. Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena. B. Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters. C. Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax. D. Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars.

Answer: A. Explanation: Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under Chausath Yogini distinction?

A. Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax. B. Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena. C. Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars. D. Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone.

Answer: B. Explanation: Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Chausath Yogini distinction?

A. Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone. B. Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls. C. Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena. D. Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars.

Answer: C. Explanation: Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Chausath Yogini distinction?

A. Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals. B. Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls. C. Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone. D. Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena.

Answer: D. Explanation: Khajuraho's early open-air granite Chausath Yogini enclosure must not be confused with the circular Kachchhapaghata-period Mitaoli temple near Morena. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Pallava transition?

A. Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters. B. Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone. C. Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax. D. Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars.

Answer: A. Explanation: Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under Pallava transition?

A. Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone. B. Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters. C. Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls. D. Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars.

Answer: B. Explanation: Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Pallava transition?

A. Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls. B. Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals. C. Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters. D. Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone.

Answer: C. Explanation: Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Pallava transition?

A. Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls. B. Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals. C. The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand. D. Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters.

Answer: D. Explanation: Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Chola achievement?

A. Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax. B. Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone. C. Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls. D. Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars.

Answer: A. Explanation: Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under Chola achievement?

A. Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals. B. Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax. C. Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone. D. Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls.

Answer: B. Explanation: Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Chola achievement?

A. The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand. B. Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals. C. Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax. D. Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls.

Answer: C. Explanation: Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Chola achievement?

A. UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management. B. Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals. C. The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand. D. Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax.

Answer: D. Explanation: Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Chalukya and Hoysala experiment?

A. Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars. B. Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone. C. Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls. D. Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals.

Answer: A. Explanation: Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under Chalukya and Hoysala experiment?

A. The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand. B. Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars. C. Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls. D. Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals.

Answer: B. Explanation: Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Chalukya and Hoysala experiment?

A. UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management. B. The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand. C. Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars. D. Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals.

Answer: C. Explanation: Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Chalukya and Hoysala experiment?

A. A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order. B. UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management. C. The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand. D. Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars.

Answer: D. Explanation: Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Vijayanagara temple-secular split?

A. Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone. B. Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls. C. Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals. D. The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand.

Answer: A. Explanation: Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under Vijayanagara temple-secular split?

A. Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals. B. Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone. C. UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management. D. The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand.

Answer: B. Explanation: Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Vijayanagara temple-secular split?

A. The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand. B. A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order. C. Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone. D. UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management.

Answer: C. Explanation: Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Vijayanagara temple-secular split?

A. A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order. B. Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhmandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels. C. UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management. D. Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone.

Answer: D. Explanation: Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Nayaka expansion?

A. Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls. B. Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals. C. The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand. D. UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management.

Answer: A. Explanation: Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under Nayaka expansion?

A. A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order. B. Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls. C. UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management. D. The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand.

Answer: B. Explanation: Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Nayaka expansion?

A. UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management. B. A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order. C. Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls. D. Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhmandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels.

Answer: C. Explanation: Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Nayaka expansion?

A. Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhmandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels. B. A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order. C. Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans. D. Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls.

Answer: D. Explanation: Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Pala-Sena eastern school?

A. Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals. B. UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management. C. The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand. D. A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order.

Answer: A. Explanation: Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under Pala-Sena eastern school?

A. A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order. B. Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals. C. UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management. D. Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhmandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels.

Answer: B. Explanation: Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Pala-Sena eastern school?

A. A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order. B. Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhmandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels. C. Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals. D. Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans.

Answer: C. Explanation: Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Pala-Sena eastern school?

A. Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans. B. Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhmandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels. C. Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram. D. Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals.

Answer: D. Explanation: Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Verified temple PYQ cluster?

A. The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand. B. UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management. C. A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order. D. Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhmandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Verified temple PYQ cluster?", every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the cultural demand in "Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Verified temple PYQ cluster?".

Analytical body:

- Claim and named evidence:** Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Verified temple PYQ cluster? **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
- Claim and named evidence:** A. The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
- Claim and named evidence:** B. UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
- Claim and named evidence:** C. A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the cultural demand in "Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Verified temple PYQ cluster?".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise five named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim

-> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

How to improve this answer: For “Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Verified temple PYQ cluster?”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.

Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Verified temple PYQ cluster?

A. Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhamandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels. B. The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand. C. Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans. D. A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Verified temple PYQ cluster?”, every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the cultural demand in “Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Verified temple PYQ cluster?”.

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Verified temple PYQ cluster?
Analysis: Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** A. Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhamandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** B. The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
- 4. Claim and named evidence:** C. Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the cultural demand in “Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Verified temple PYQ cluster?”.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise five named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

How to improve this answer: For “Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Verified temple PYQ cluster?”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.

Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Verified temple PYQ cluster?

A. Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhamandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels. B. Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram. C. The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand. D. Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Demand decoding: Treat “Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Verified temple PYQ cluster?” as a form, chronology, region, patron, medium and status problem. Verify every pairing independently without inventing an official key.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the cultural demand in “Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Verified temple PYQ cluster?”.

Analytical body:

- Claim and named evidence:** Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Verified temple PYQ cluster? **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
- Claim and named evidence:** A. Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhamandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
- Claim and named evidence:** B. Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
- Claim and named evidence:** C. The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the cultural demand in “Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Verified temple PYQ cluster?”.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: Fix the category and period; pair form with region, material, patron or institution; separate historical fact from later label or current recognition; eliminate the closest distractor.

Why this earns marks: It preserves answer-text integrity and exact category mapping while keeping reasoned elimination separate from an official key.

How to improve this answer: For “Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Verified temple PYQ cluster?”, state why the nearest distractor fails on medium, region, chronology, patronage, terminology or recognition status.

Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Verified temple PYQ cluster?

A. Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida. B. Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram. C. Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans. D. The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Official Khajuraho linkage?

A. UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management. B. Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans. C. A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order. D. Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhamandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels.

Answer: A. Explanation: UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under Official Khajuraho linkage?

A. Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans. B. UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management. C. Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhamandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels. D. Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram.

Answer: B. Explanation: UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Official Khajuraho linkage?

A. Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida. B. Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram. C. UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management. D. Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans.

Answer: C. Explanation: UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Official Khajuraho linkage?

A. Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida. B. Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram. C. Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context. D. UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management.

Answer: D. Explanation: UNESCO's official property page describes axial Nagara spaces, clustered spires and sacred-secular sculptural themes under ASI management. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Temple answer spine?

A. A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order. B. Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans. C. Garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala, ardhmandapa, pradakshina patha, vahana and platform describe a ritual sequence rather than decorative labels. D. Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram.

Answer: A. Explanation: A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Temple answer spine?

A. Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida. B. A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order. C. Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram. D. Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans.

Answer: B. Explanation: A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Temple answer spine?

A. Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida. B. Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram. C. A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order. D. Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context.

Answer: C. Explanation: A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Temple answer spine?

A. Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida. B. A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas. C. Jejabhukti's Chandellas used temple patronage during political self-assertion, with Dhanga's maharajadhiraja title providing the key sovereignty context. D. A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order.

Answer: D. Explanation: A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Demand decoding: Treat “Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Verified temple PYQ cluster?” as a form, chronology, region, patron, medium and status problem. Verify every pairing independently without inventing an official key.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the cultural demand in “Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Verified temple PYQ cluster?”.

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Verified temple PYQ cluster? **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** A. Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** B. Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
- 4. Claim and named evidence:** C. Early structural temples moved from flat-roofed square shrines through raised and circumambulatory plans toward shikhara, panchayatana and varied ground plans. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the cultural demand in “Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Verified temple PYQ cluster?”.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: Fix the category and period; pair form with region, material, patron or institution; separate historical fact from later label or current recognition; eliminate the closest distractor.

Why this earns marks: It preserves answer-text integrity and exact category mapping while keeping reasoned elimination separate from an official key.

How to improve this answer: For “Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Verified temple PYQ cluster?”, state why the nearest distractor fails on medium, region, chronology, patronage, terminology or recognition status.

VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

Verified owned Mains routes are the 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand, and the routed 2022 demand on medieval temple sculpture as social evidence. The 2026 objective route remains provisionally keyed and is not solved.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

7. Exact PYQ application

FACT: 2025 Q3, verbatim: "The sculptors filled the Chandella artform with resilient vigor and breadth of life.' Elucidate. (Answer in 150 words)" (UPSC Mains 2025 GS Paper 1.txt:14-18). **ANALYSIS:** A 150-word answer should: (i) name Khajuraho/Chandella Nagara architecture briefly; (ii) show "resilient vigour" through the dynamism of figural sculpture - dancers, musicians, divine and secular figures, mithuna couples, Vyalas - in active, twisting postures rather than static poses; (iii) show "breadth of life" through the sculptural programme's range (deities, courtly life, ascetics, animals, erotic imagery as one part among many); (iv) close by naming Kandariya Mahadeva as the culminating example and the 1986 UNESCO inscription as the current-status anchor.

FACT: 2024 Q2, verbatim: "Estimate the contribution of Pallavas of Kanchi for the development of art and literature of South India. (Answer in 150 words)" (UPSC Mains 2024 GS Paper I.txt:15-20). **ANALYSIS:** Answer should cite: Pallava temple architecture beginning under Mahendravarman I (610-630 AD); A.H. Longhurst's four chronological styles (Mahendravarman, Mamalla, Rajasimha, Nandivarman); the Mahabalipuram monolithic Pancha Rathas and Shore Temple (UNESCO 1984); Kanchipuram as capital and centre of Sanskrit scholarship (Dandin's *Avantisundari Katha*) - literature contribution belongs jointly to topic 11.

FACT: 2024 Q11, verbatim: "Though the great Cholas are no more yet their name is still remembered with great pride because of their highest achievements in the domain of art and architecture. Comment. (Answer in 250 words)" (UPSC Mains 2024 GS Paper I.txt:77-82). **ANALYSIS:** Answer should cite: Brihadishvara Temple, Thanjavur (built by Rajaraja I in the early eleventh century, also called Rajarajeshvara, Periya Kovil and Dakshina Meru) - a fully granite temple with a huge vimana that the book describes as about 60 m tall; the "Great Living Chola Temples" UNESCO inscription (Thanjavur 1987; Gangaikondacholapuram and Darasuram added 2004); Chola bronze sculpture, especially the Nataraja (developed fully in topic 06); the elaborate temple-administration Tamil inscription at Airavatesvara Temple as evidence of institutional sophistication. **WRONG:** Do not quote a decimal vimana height or a precise consecration year: this folder's sources support "early 11th century" and "about 60 m," and any more exact figure must come from a separately cited dated source.

2026 PYQ Integration

Status: 2026 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2026.md. **Answer-key rule:** The 2026 Prelims and CSAT Set-A keys held locally are **provisional**; no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Year represented:** 2026
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2026	Prelims GS-I	4	Nagara-style shikhara among early Indian temple architecture examples	Objective question; provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally, answer not inferred	Provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally (Ans-2026-GS1-Provisional); key is provisional - no answer letter recorded or inferred here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Nagara-style shikhara among early Indian temple architecture examples

This block integrates the 2026 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 blocks and does not convert a provisionally-keyed, answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2024-2025.md.

- **Years represented:** 2024, 2025
- **Paper(s):** GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 2

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	GS-I	11	Cholas' achievements in art and architecture	Comment · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2025	GS-I	3	Chandella artform - resilient vigour and breadth of life	Elucidate · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Cholas' achievements in art and architecture
- Chandella artform - resilient vigour and breadth of life

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2021
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2021	Prelims GS-I	31	Chausath Yogini Temple Morena Kachchhapaghata architecture	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Chausath Yogini Temple Morena Kachchhapaghata architecture

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

8. Exact PYQ application

FACT: **2025 Q3, verbatim:** "The sculptors filled the Chandella artform with resilient vigor and breadth of life."

Elucidate. (Answer in 150 words)" (UPSC Mains 2025 GS Paper 1.txt:14-18). ANALYSIS: **Advanced-tier answer architecture:** (i) name Dhanga's political autonomy as the enabling condition for ambitious temple patronage; (ii) define "resilient vigour" through the dynamic, muscular, multi-postured figural style across the **entire** programme; (iii) define "breadth of life" through the programme's range (deities, secular life, ascetics, animals, intimacy) and the plural Shaiva-Vaishnava-Jain patronage as evidence of "life" in its full civilisational sense, not only erotic content; (iv) close with Kandariya Mahadeva as the culminating case and the 1986 UNESCO inscription as the current-status anchor - all within 150 words, which requires tight, non-redundant phrasing.

FACT: **2024 Q11 (Cholas), cross-reference:** the Great Living Chola Temples' comparative vimana/gopuram model (Section 3) supplies a contrast case for any answer that must distinguish Nagara (Khajuraho) from Dravida (Chola) achievement in the same essay.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2025 GS-I

Demand: 'The sculptors filled the Chandella artform with resilient vigor and breadth of life.' Elucidate. (Answer in 150 words)

Status: Verified verbatim in the Basic owner.

Model solution: Separate vigour as carving method from breadth as subject range; cite sandstone, dynamic figures, sacred and secular registers, vyalas and maithuna as one element; close with Kandariya Mahadeva.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2025 GS-I", every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Separate vigour as carving method from breadth as subject range; cite sandstone, dynamic figures, sacred and secular registers, vyalas and maithuna as one element; close with Kandariya Mahadeva.

Qualification: Bound the claim by period, region, medium, patronage and evidence status; do not convert similarity into direct descent or a commissioned representation into a social census.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise five named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2025 GS-I", replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2024 GS-I

Demand: Estimate the contribution of Pallavas of Kanchi for the development of art and literature of South India. (Answer in 150 words)

Status: Verified verbatim in the Basic owner.

Model solution: Estimate the rock-cut to monolithic to structural sequence through Mandagapattu, Pancha Rathas and Shore Temple, then add Kanchipuram, murals, inscriptions and Dandin with a survival limitation.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2024 GS-I", every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Estimate the rock-cut to monolithic to structural sequence through Mandagapattu, Pancha Rathas and Shore Temple, then add Kanchipuram, murals, inscriptions and Dandin with a survival limitation.

Qualification: Bound the claim by period, region, medium, patronage and evidence status; do not convert similarity into direct descent or a commissioned representation into a social census.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise five named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

How to improve this answer: For “PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2024 GS-I”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2024 GS-I

Demand: Though the great Cholas are no more yet their name is still remembered with great pride because of their highest achievements in the domain of art and architecture. Comment. (Answer in 250 words)

Status: Verified verbatim in the Basic owner.

Model solution: Use Brihadishvara for granite scale, Nataraja for bronze, murals and inscriptions for cultural-administrative depth, and the living UNESCO serial property for afterlife; qualify labour and incomplete survivals.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2024 GS-I”, every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Use Brihadishvara for granite scale, Nataraja for bronze, murals and inscriptions for cultural-administrative depth, and the living UNESCO serial property for afterlife; qualify labour and incomplete survivals.

Qualification: Bound the claim by period, region, medium, patronage and evidence status; do not convert similarity into direct descent or a commissioned representation into a social census.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise five named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

How to improve this answer: For “PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2024 GS-I”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2022 GS-I

Demand: Medieval Indian temple sculptures represent the social life of those days. How will you explain this statement?

Status: Verified routed wording in the Core owner.

Model solution: Use dancers and musicians, teachers and disciples, courtly scenes, patron women and named artisans as selected evidence; state that commissioned images are representations, not a statistical photograph of society.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2022 GS-I”, every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Use dancers and musicians, teachers and disciples, courtly scenes, patron women and named artisans as selected evidence; state that commissioned images are representations, not a statistical

photograph of society.

Qualification: Bound the claim by period, region, medium, patronage and evidence status; do not convert similarity into direct descent or a commissioned representation into a social census.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise five named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

How to improve this answer: For “PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2022 GS-I”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Elucidate the resilient vigour and breadth of life in Chandella art. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Khajuraho's vigour comes from dynamic carving integrated with sandstone walls; breadth comes from its sacred, social, animal, performance and intimate registers, of which maithuna is only one.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas.
- Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim.
- Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom.
- Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth.
- The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture.

Qualified conclusion: Khajuraho's vigour comes from dynamic carving integrated with sandstone walls; breadth comes from its sacred, social, animal, performance and intimate registers, of which maithuna is only one.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Elucidate the resilient vigour and breadth of life in Chandella art. Answer in about 150...”, every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Khajuraho's vigour comes from dynamic carving integrated with sandstone walls; breadth comes from its sacred, social, animal, performance and intimate registers, of which maithuna is only one.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Most temples use fine-grained sandstone on open terraces without an enclosure wall, while granite exceptions prevent a uniform-material claim. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain dedications share the Khajuraho landscape and regional architectural idiom. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** The largest and loftiest Khajuraho temple is the culminating case for mature Nagara massing and integrated sculpture. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

Qualified conclusion: Khajuraho's vigour comes from dynamic carving integrated with sandstone walls; breadth comes from its sacred, social, animal, performance and intimate registers, of which maithuna is only one.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise three named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

How to improve this answer: For "Elucidate the resilient vigour and breadth of life in Chandella art. Answer in about 150...", replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Estimate the Pallava contribution to South Indian art and architecture. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: The Pallava achievement was a transition from excavated mandapas to monolithic experiments and structural temples, joined to mural and Sanskrit-Tamil literary patronage.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters.

Qualified conclusion: The Pallava achievement was a transition from excavated mandapas to monolithic experiments and structural temples, joined to mural and Sanskrit-Tamil literary patronage.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Estimate the Pallava contribution to South Indian art and architecture. Answer in about 150...", every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The Pallava achievement was a transition from excavated mandapas to monolithic experiments and structural temples, joined to mural and Sanskrit-Tamil literary patronage.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

Qualified conclusion: The Pallava achievement was a transition from excavated mandapas to monolithic experiments and structural temples, joined to mural and Sanskrit-Tamil literary patronage.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise three named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

How to improve this answer: For “Estimate the Pallava contribution to South Indian art and architecture. Answer in about 150...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Why are the Cholas remembered for art and architecture? Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Monumental granite building, portable bronzes, murals, inscriptions, administration and continuing worship survive together, giving Chola patronage both scale and living afterlife.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax.

Qualified conclusion: Monumental granite building, portable bronzes, murals, inscriptions, administration and continuing worship survive together, giving Chola patronage both scale and living afterlife.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Why are the Cholas remembered for art and architecture? Answer in about 250 words.”, every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Monumental granite building, portable bronzes, murals, inscriptions, administration and continuing worship survive together, giving Chola patronage both scale and living afterlife.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

Qualified conclusion: Monumental granite building, portable bronzes, murals, inscriptions, administration and continuing worship survive together, giving Chola patronage both scale and living afterlife.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise five named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

How to improve this answer: For “Why are the Cholas remembered for art and architecture? Answer in about 250 words.”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Temple sculpture is selected evidence of medieval social life. Explain. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Performance, learning, courtly activity, ritual and labour appear in commissioned programmes, but representation records what patrons made visible rather than society statistically.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyalas and maithuna create breadth.

- The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand.

Qualified conclusion: Performance, learning, courtly activity, ritual and labour appear in commissioned programmes, but representation records what patrons made visible rather than society statistically.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on “Temple sculpture is selected evidence of medieval social life. Explain. Answer in about 250...”, every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Performance, learning, courtly activity, ritual and labour appear in commissioned programmes, but representation records what patrons made visible rather than society statistically.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Dynamic figures and deep carving create vigour, while deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly scenes, vyālas and maithuna create breadth. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The Core owner supports direct 2024 Pallava and Chola demands, the 2025 Chandella demand and the routed 2022 temple-sculpture social-life demand. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

Qualified conclusion: Performance, learning, courtly activity, ritual and labour appear in commissioned programmes, but representation records what patrons made visible rather than society statistically.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise five named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

How to improve this answer: For “Temple sculpture is selected evidence of medieval social life. Explain. Answer in about 250...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Trace the development of South Indian temple architecture from Pallava to Nayaka. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: The organising movement is rock-cut to structural temple, imperial vimana, Deccan experiment, gateway-dominated Vijayanagara complex and Nayaka enclosure expansion.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters.
- Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax.
- Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars.
- Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone.
- Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls.

Qualified conclusion: The organising movement is rock-cut to structural temple, imperial vimana, Deccan experiment, gateway-dominated Vijayanagara complex and Nayaka enclosure expansion.

Demand decoding: The directive **trace** requires a direct position on “Trace the development of South Indian temple architecture from Pallava to Nayaka. Answer in...”, every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The organising movement is rock-cut to structural temple, imperial vimana, Deccan experiment, gateway-dominated Vijayanagara complex and Nayaka enclosure expansion.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Pallava patronage moved from rock-cut mandapas to monolithic rathas and structural temples, with Mahabalipuram and Kanchipuram linking architecture, painting and letters. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Chola legacy combines monumental granite temples, bronze icons, murals, inscriptions and living ritual, with Brihadishvara as the architectural climax. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Hampi's temples extend Dravida gopuram and mandapa forms, while Islamic arches and domes are strongest in the royal and secular zone. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Nayaka building enlarged older complexes through graded gopurams, prakarams, temple tanks, stucco superstructures and processional halls. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

Qualified conclusion: The organising movement is rock-cut to structural temple, imperial vimana, Deccan experiment, gateway-dominated Vijayanagara complex and Nayaka enclosure expansion.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise six to eight named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

How to improve this answer: For “Trace the development of South Indian temple architecture from Pallava to Nayaka. Answer in...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Compare major regional schools of Indian temple architecture. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Nagara, Dravida, Deccan and eastern schools differ through tower, enclosure, plan, material and patronage; named monuments reveal a family of regional solutions, not rigid boxes.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram.
- Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida.
- A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas.
- Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars.
- Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals.
- A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order.

Qualified conclusion: Nagara, Dravida, Deccan and eastern schools differ through tower, enclosure, plan, material and patronage; named monuments reveal a family of regional solutions, not rigid boxes.

Demand decoding: The directive **compare** requires a direct position on "Compare major regional schools of Indian temple architecture. Answer in about 300 words.", every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Nagara, Dravida, Deccan and eastern schools differ through tower, enclosure, plan, material and patronage; named monuments reveal a family of regional solutions, not rigid boxes.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Nagara commonly emphasises a curvilinear sanctum shikhara; Dravida organises a walled axial complex with a tiered vimana and increasingly prominent gopuram. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Vesara is best used after describing Deccan plan, tower and material; it is not a mechanically equal mixture of Nagara and Dravida. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** A high jagati supports ardhmandapa, mandapa, antarala and garbhagriha beneath a clustered shikhara of urushringas. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal and Hoysala stellate soapstone temples demonstrate Deccan selection from northern and southern grammars. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Bengal's brick and terracotta architecture joined Buddhist and Hindu patronage and translated the bamboo-hut roof into the Bangla roof later used by Mughals. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** A strong answer names school, morphology, patron, monument, sculptural programme, comparison, evidence limit and heritage status in that order. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique,

patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

Qualified conclusion: Nagara, Dravida, Deccan and eastern schools differ through tower, enclosure, plan, material and patronage; named monuments reveal a family of regional solutions, not rigid boxes.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise six to eight named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

How to improve this answer: For “Compare major regional schools of Indian temple architecture. Answer in about 300 words.”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.